

AURA Dealership OS

Complete User Manual

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Covers every module and page of the AURA workspace and the AURA Realm platform console

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1. Getting Started & Signing In

Accessing AURA

Open your dealership's AURA address in a web browser. The public landing page introduces the product; staff sign in from `/sign-in` (there is also a `/sign-up` page for invited users completing registration).

1. Click **Sign in** and enter your work email and password (accounts are managed by your administrator under Settings → Team).
2. On first sign-in you land on your role's home page — for example, sales advisors go to the Pipeline, managers to My Day.
3. If your account belongs to more than one dealership, a dealership picker appears; choose the one you want to work in. You can switch at any time from the header.

No dealership yet? If you sign in and see a "no dealership" screen, your account has not been added to a dealership team. Ask your General Manager to add you under Settings → Team.

Public test-drive booking

Customers can book test drives without an account through a personal link (`/book-test-drive/...`) sent to them by your sales team via WhatsApp or email. Bookings made this way appear in Capacity and on the lead's timeline.

2. Navigation, Roles & Permissions

The sidebar

The workspace is organised into clusters:

Cluster	Pages
Insights & Actions	My Day (Command Center), Reports
Sales	Pipeline, Deals, Finance
Operations	Inventory, Capacity, Deliveries, Service, Parts
Accounts	Accounts (customers)
Settings	Profile, Team, Roles, Lead Sources, Lead Stages, Tax Rules, Audit, Branding, Email, ERPNext, Meta Lead Ads, WhatsApp

What you see depends on your role

- **Managers** (General, Sales, Service, Finance Managers, Dealer Admin) see the full clustered menu.
- **Advisors and technicians** (Sales Advisor, Delivery Advisor, Service Advisor, Technician, Parts Advisor, marketing roles) see a focused menu with just the pages they use; extra items appear only when their role has view permission.
- Every menu item, page and action is governed by **role permissions** (view / create / edit, per module) configured under Settings → Roles & Permissions. If you cannot see a page or button that a colleague can, your role does not include it.
- **Service** and **Parts** additionally require the dealership to have those modules enabled for its plan.

Money throughout the system is in **Guyanese dollars (GYD)** — quotes, invoices, duties, reports.

3. My Day — Command Center

My Day (`/command-center`) is your daily triage screen. It combines everything needing attention into a single action queue, plus KPI summaries with drill-through to sales, pipeline, deliveries and service.

The action queue

- Cards cover **approvals waiting on you, overdue and upcoming tasks, lead follow-ups breaching SLA, deliveries in progress, and service alerts.**
- Filter by type, severity, or date (including a Today view); use the search box to find a specific card; pagination keeps long queues manageable.
- Clicking a card opens the underlying record. Approval cards open the decision dialog directly (see chapter 9).

Counts and cards are scoped to *you* — your role, your permissions and your dealership. A sales advisor sees their own leads' follow-ups; a manager also sees pending approvals.

The old Calendar page has been merged into My Day; the `/calendar` link redirects here.

4. Pipeline — Leads & Enquiries

The Pipeline (/pipeline) is where every enquiry lives, from first contact to delivered vehicle.

Lead stages

Leads progress through eight stages, grouped in four phases:

Phase	Stages
Lead	New → Contacted → Engaged
Pre-Booking	Pre-Book → Vehicle Allocated
Payment	Payment
Delivery	Pre-Delivery → Delivered

Stage advancement can require specific fields or documents — these requirements are configured by your admin under Settings → Lead Stages and are enforced when you try to advance.

Creating a lead

1. Click **New Lead**.
2. Enter the customer's name, phone, email and address (required), pick the **source** (walk-in, referral, Facebook, etc. — the list is configurable). Social sources ask for the platform.
3. Optionally set the interested model, link or create a retail customer account, set priority and notes.

Leads also arrive automatically from **Facebook/Instagram Lead Ads, WhatsApp** conversations, and **email enquiries** — these appear with their source set accordingly, ready to be picked up or auto-assigned.

Working the list

- Tabs: **All, Mine, Lead, Pre-Booking, Payment, Delivery, Lost**.
- Search by name, model, location, branch, phone or email; sort any column; switch between list and table views.
- SLA and triage indicators highlight leads waiting too long for first contact or follow-up. Ownership (which advisor a lead belongs to) is always visible.

Unassigned leads are automatically routed to active sales advisors after a few minutes, and the customer receives a welcome email introducing their advisor — so claim new leads promptly.

5. Lead Workbench (Lead Detail)

Open any lead to reach its workbench (/lead/...) — the single place to run the whole customer conversation.

- **Stage rail** — advance the lead through its stages; requirements are validated as you go.
- **Calls** — call the customer and log outcomes.
- **WhatsApp panel** — read the full WhatsApp conversation and send messages/templates without leaving the page (see chapter 20). Quotes can be sent as PDF documents over WhatsApp.
- **Test drives** — book a slot directly or send the customer a self-booking link; capacity rules prevent double-booking (chapter 12).
- **Notes & documents** — keep the paper trail: quotes, IDs, correspondence.
- **Customer linking** — connect the lead to an existing customer account, or create one.

One lead should carry one active buying journey. If the same person enquires again later, the existing conversation and history stay attached to them.

6. Deals

The Deals page (`/deals`) tracks every negotiation from desking to committed sale.

Desking a new deal

1. Click **Desk a New Deal**.
2. Attach the lead, vehicle and customer; enter the price; apply a discount (fixed amount or percentage); choose the stage and payment method (cash, bank financing, cheque).

Working deals

- Kanban pipeline and list views; open a deal to edit terms, start a finance application, generate a quote, or message the customer on WhatsApp.
- **Cancelling** a deal requires a reason (customer changed mind, financing declined, bought elsewhere, price, delay, defect, duplicate, other) plus context.
- **Discounts beyond policy** (e.g. below floor price) automatically raise a manager approval gate — the deal waits until it is approved or adjusted (chapter 9).

Deals have **no manual stage jump to "delivered"**. A committed deal advances automatically: finance disbursement commits it, and completing the nine-step delivery workflow (chapter 13) delivers it. This keeps the paper trail honest.

7. Quotes & Discounts

Quotes are built from within a deal — there is no separate quotes page.

- Build a quote from the deal's vehicle and pricing; totals (including taxes) are computed by the server from your dealership's tax rules.
- Apply a discount as an amount or percentage and give a rationale. Discounts within policy apply immediately; over-policy discounts create an approval gate for a manager.
- A **regenerated quote supersedes** any pending discount approval for the old version.
- Send the quote to the customer as a PDF via WhatsApp directly from the lead workbench.

8. Finance — Credit, Invoices & Payments

The Finance page (/finance) manages lending applications, invoices and payments.

Credit applications

1. Click **New Credit Application**. You can prefill from a lead and link the customer.
2. Capture the applicant, lender, amount financed, down payment, term, APR, employer, employment type/years and income.
3. Submit to the lender; track status through review, approval or decline. Attach supporting documents on the application detail.
4. A declined application raises a gate for manager review — the manager can accept the decline or send it back to under-review.

The list of banks/lenders is managed on this page.

Invoices & payments

- Create invoices against a customer/deal with line items and totals; record payments with method and reference (cash, transfer, cheque).
- Track settlement — paid, outstanding balance, credits and adjustments (adjustments require a reason).
- Refunds are strictly controlled: releasing a refund requires an approved gate, and is capped at the approved amount (chapter 9).

Finance disbursement is what commits a financed deal — once the lender pays out, the deal moves forward automatically.

9. Approvals (Gates)

Sensitive actions in AURA never execute on one person's say-so. They raise an **approval gate** that an authorised manager must resolve. Gates appear on My Day and inside the record they relate to.

Gate	Raised when	On approval
Below floor price / quote discount	A discount exceeds policy	The discounted price is authorised and applied
Credit decline	A lender declines an application	Decline stands, or adjust back to under-review
Capital order	Stock purchase needs sign-off	Vehicle moves to in-transit
GRA filing	A duty sheet is sent for review	Filing to GRA is unlocked
Refund release	A deposit/payment refund is requested	Refund can be executed, capped at the approved amount; the vehicle is released

Deciding a gate

- Open the gate card to see the evidence and context, then **Approve**, **Adjust** (approve with changed figures), or **Reject/Dismiss**.
- A **justification is mandatory** — blank or whitespace-only reasons are rejected, and the decision is recorded in the audit timeline under your name.
- Rejection sends the request back for correction; the underlying record stays blocked (e.g. a vehicle stays held) until a decision is made.

10. GRA Customs Duty Filing

Duty filing for imported vehicles is handled inside the pipeline/delivery workflow (the old `/gra` link redirects to the Pipeline).

1. **Prepare the duty sheet** — upload or select the duty document; enter CIF value, year of import, FOB, freight and insurance. Identity fields are keyed by hand; figures extracted from documents are restricted to a safe allowlist.
2. **Server-computed duty** — duty and levy lines are computed on the server from your dealership's tax rules (Settings → Tax Rules) and shown read-only. The app never trusts a browser-side calculation.
3. **Send for review** — an authorised officer reviews the sheet as an approval gate. Only an approved (or adjusted) gate unlocks filing.
4. **File to GRA** — generates the duty-pack PDF for download and submission, recomputing at filing time and checking every line for drift against what was approved. Registration state is tracked (pending → submitted to GRA → plate issued) through delivery.

If a duty figure changed since approval (for example a tax rule was edited), filing stops and the sheet must be re-approved — this is deliberate.

11. Inventory & Vehicle Detail

Inventory (</inventory>) is the vehicle master list for your dealership.

Finding and viewing vehicles

- Search by make, model or year; filter by body type, powertrain (EV / Hybrid / Petrol / Diesel) and division; switch card/table views.
- Cards show availability, allocation/reservation, and the deal/customer a vehicle is attached to.
- Open a vehicle (</vehicle/...>) for full identity, specification, pricing, photos, status history and linked deals.

Adding stock

- **Add vehicle** — full form covering identity/specification, pricing, duty-free amount, stock/status, location/division, VIN and photos.
- **Import** — download the XLSX template, fill it (required: Make, Model, Year, Price, Powertrain, Mileage, Exterior Color, Body Type; VIN and Engine Number must be 17 characters when present) and upload. Rows with problems are reported so you can fix and re-import.

VINs are unique within your dealership — a duplicate active VIN will be rejected. Use export → edit → re-import (keyed by Inventory ID) to correct vehicle data in bulk.

12. Capacity — Test-Drive Planning

Capacity (/capacity) controls when test drives can happen.

- Define bookable hours and block out slots per hour.
- Block a **model** for a period — model blocks apply to every unit of that model, across all vehicles.
- Bookings made by staff (lead workbench) and by customers (public self-booking link) both respect these rules, preventing double-booking.

13. Deliveries & Bookings

Deliveries (/deliveries) manages the handover of sold vehicles, in three tabs: **Active**, **Completed** and **Bookings**.

The nine-step delivery workflow

Each delivery advances step by step through a checklist (including PDI — pre-delivery inspection). For every step you can:

- Complete it once its requirements are met (some steps require data such as the customer's signature, plate number or delivery date before they can complete);
- Edit step details and notes;
- **Skip** it explicitly — skipping bypasses the step's requirements and is recorded.

What you manage on a delivery

- Assign the delivery advisor and sales advisor.
- Capture registration state (pending → submitted to GRA → plate issued) and insurance policy/provider.
- Record customer comments and signature at handover.
- Send the warranty email; send booking-payment reminders; mark bookings paid; see payment/expiry state.

Cancelling

Cancelling a delivery/booking with a refund requires manager approval via a refund-release gate. The vehicle remains held until the gate is decided.

14. Service & Workshop

Service (/service) combines bookings, workshop job cards, coverage and service invoicing (the old Workshop page was merged in). Tabs: **Bookings, Jobs, Coverage, Invoices, My Jobs**.

Booking & job flow

1. **Book service** — pick the customer and vehicle, appointment time and the complaint/request.
2. **Open the job card** — assign a technician, advance job status as work proceeds.
3. **Diagnose** — capture diagnosis, root cause and work performed; attach checklists; record severity; add warranty/coverage where applicable.
4. **Parts** — issue parts to the job from stock and return unused ones; movements are tracked.
5. **Close & invoice** — generate the service invoice; apply discounts/adjustments (with reason), create credit notes, or carry the job over with a reason.

After-sales cases with severity levels are supported for complaints and follow-ups. Technicians use **My Jobs** to see only their assigned work.

Service orders link to the customer's garage vehicle, so history accumulates against the actual car.

15. Parts, Suppliers & Purchasing

Parts (/parts) manages the parts catalogue and stock. Tabs: **Parts, Suppliers, Purchase Orders, Purchases.**

- **Parts** — add/edit parts (SKU, name, cost, price), search by name or SKU, import in bulk. A cost-plus markup setting auto-prices imported parts.
- **Suppliers** — maintain the supplier list.
- **Purchase Orders** — raise POs on suppliers, then **receive stock** against them when goods arrive.
- **Adjustments** — record manual stock movements with notes when counts change outside of purchasing/service.
- Issuing and returning parts on workshop jobs happens from the Service module and is reflected here.

If ERPNext sync is enabled (chapter 21), items, purchase receipts and stock movements flow to/from your ERPNext instance automatically.

16. Accounts (Customers)

Accounts (/customers) is the customer master.

- Search and list accounts; add a new account; open the detail page (/customers/...).
- **Profile** — name, email, phone, WhatsApp, date of birth, occupation/company, address, TIN, loyalty tier.
- **Care** — after-sales interactions and ratings.
- **Documents & Notes** — IDs, agreements and the running relationship record.
- **Privacy** — export the customer's data as a JSON bundle or erase it (requires customer-admin permission; deletion is confirmation-gated). Communications default to transactional-only.
- The detail page links across to the customer's leads, deals, finance records, invoices and conversations.

Keep phone numbers in full international format (e.g. +592...) so WhatsApp messages and service reminders reach the customer.

17. Reports

Reports (/reports) provides role-scoped performance dashboards: revenue, pipeline conversion, delivery and service throughput, and persona-based analytics.

- Pick a report and date range; charts and cards update accordingly.
- **Export** — download server-generated report files in the formats offered; failures are reported and audited.
- What you can see follows your role — for example, roles without money permissions see reports with monetary figures redacted.

18. Notifications & Tasks

- The **bell** in the header lists unread in-app notifications — assignments, approvals, ratings, sync issues — and takes you to the record.
- **Tasks** (follow-ups, reminders) surface on My Day's action queue with overdue/upcoming grouping.
- Email notifications are sent for key events (lead assignment, approvals, SLA breaches, warranty) through your dealership's configured email connection (chapter 21).

19. Settings — Administration

Settings pages (under `/settings`) require the settings permission; **Profile** is available to everyone.

Page	What you manage
Profile	Your own identity and contact details.
Team	Invite/add staff by email; assign role, manager, phone, division; activate/deactivate accounts.
Roles & Permissions	Create roles and set module-by-module permissions (view/create/edit...). "View" is an explicit switch — a role with edit but not view will not see the module.
Lead Sources	Add/edit/activate the sources offered on New Lead; social sources ask for the platform.
Lead Stages	Configure the requirements to advance each stage; saving publishes a new version that applies immediately.
Tax Rules	Ordered percentage/fixed tax and duty rules with optional price thresholds and notes — these drive quote totals and GRA duty computation. All amounts GYD.
Audit	Search every sign-in and change by actor, action and module, newest first.
Branding	Dealership identity and logo used across the app and printed documents (white-label).
Email	Per-dealership SMTP (Gmail app password), test/enable/disable, outbound queue monitoring and template overrides.
ERPNext	Accounting sync — see chapter 21.
Meta Lead Ads / WhatsApp	Social lead capture and messaging — see chapter 20.

Changing tax rules affects new quotes and duty sheets immediately. Already-approved duty gates will fail the drift check at filing and need re-approval.

20. WhatsApp & Meta Lead Ads

WhatsApp (Settings → WhatsApp)

- Connect your Meta Business WhatsApp number (phone number ID, business account ID, access token); pick and manage message templates and language; test and enable the connection.
- Once connected, staff message customers from the **lead workbench WhatsApp panel**. Free-form replies are possible within 24 hours of the customer's last message; outside that window a pre-approved template must be used.
- Inbound WhatsApp messages create or update leads automatically and appear in the conversation thread; quote PDFs can be sent as documents.
- Each dealership sends only from its own number — there is no shared fallback sender.

Meta Lead Ads (Settings → Meta Lead Ads)

- Connect your Facebook Page with a page access token; the connection banner warns before a token expires.
- New Facebook/Instagram lead-form submissions flow straight into the Pipeline with source "facebook", deduplicated against existing leads.
- A backfill can import historical campaign leads on request; imported leads arrive unassigned with their original submission dates.

21. ERPNext & Email Integrations

ERPNext (Settings → ERPNext)

- Configure your instance URL, API key/secret (secret can be rotated), company, and the accounts for sales, VAT, debtors and cash; test and enable.
- Customers, sales invoices, payment entries, parts items, purchase receipts and stock movements sync through a queued, retry-safe pipeline that deduplicates — you can safely queue existing records for first-time sync.
- If the connection is not configured, outgoing changes park in the queue without failing; they sync once you connect. Sync failures are visible and, when they pile up, managers are alerted.

Email (Settings → Email)

- Per-dealership Gmail SMTP: host, port, security, user and app password. Test the connection, send a test message, enable/disable, and monitor the outbound queue.
- All customer and staff emails (assignments, reminders, warranty, approvals) send through this connection — if it is disabled, emails queue but do not send.

22. AURA Realm — Platform Console

Realm (/realm/) is the separate console for **platform super-administrators** — dealership staff never see it.

Page	Purpose
Command Overview	Network-wide health and KPIs.
Dealership Network	All dealerships; open one for detail. Provision new dealerships (10-step saga with retry/resume), suspend/resume, offboard with data export and retention clock, and close.
AI Agents	Global and per-dealer agent kill switches and policies.
Meta Lead Ads	Platform-level Meta connection oversight.
Platform Users	Super-admin and cross-dealer user management.
Platform Audit Log	Every platform-level action.

Super-admins access dealer data only through time-boxed, reasoned **impersonation grants** (read-only or elevated; money-posting always blocked), all audited.

23. Frequently Asked Questions

I can't see a page/button my colleague has.

Your role lacks that module's permission. Ask an admin to check Settings → Roles & Permissions (remember "view" must be ticked explicitly).

Why can't I move a deal to delivered?

Deals advance through events: finance disbursement commits them, the delivery workflow delivers them. Complete the delivery steps instead.

Why was my discount not applied immediately?

It exceeded policy and created a manager approval gate. Track it on the deal or ask your manager to decide it from My Day.

Duty figures look different from my spreadsheet.

Duty is computed server-side from Settings → Tax Rules. Check the rules and thresholds there; the on-screen breakdown shows each line.

WhatsApp won't let me type a free message.

The customer's 24-hour reply window has closed. Send an approved template; the window reopens when they reply.

A vehicle import row failed.

Check required columns (Make, Model, Year, Price, Powertrain, Mileage, Exterior Color, Body Type), the Powertrain enum (EV/Hybrid/Petrol/Diesel), 17-character VIN/Engine Number, and duplicate VINs.

Emails aren't going out.

Settings → Email: confirm the connection is enabled and passing its test; check the outbound queue for failures.